Institution: Martin Von Wagner Museum
Registration Number: L265 and L282
Beazley Archive Number: 310451
Fabric: Athenian, black-figure
Shape: Type A panel amphora, special model
Attribution: Amasis Painter, Dümmler
Date: ~575–525 BCE
Dimensions: H. with lid: 42.15cm; without lid 34.5-34.8cm; W. across handles 27.0cm
Provenance: Acquired from Feoli collection in 1872, perhaps from Vulci

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Fabric, Technique, Shape & Condition
Attic black-figure panel-amphora, Type A (special model), in characteristic orange-red Attic clay.[1] Figures are rendered in black slip on reserved ground with incised interior details. Added red and white are used for select details on the decoration including manes, stripes, and the skin of dancing Maenads, though the added colours have disappeared due to surface fretting. The shape of the vessel is intact with the lid preserved. The surface is fretted on both panels, with panel B more severely affected, including some loss to the black slip itself in addition to the added colours.

Iconography The amphora's decorative programme is organised across 4 distinct registers: neck, body panel, and the two handle zones. The thematic content traces a coherent narrative arc from divine sanction of wine through production to consumption. Neck A depicts Dionysos enthroned on a campstool between groups of dancing maenads and satyrs, establishing the god's presiding role over the scenes below. Neck B continues the Dionysiac thiasos with satyrs and maenads in an animated dance.

Fig. 1. Martin von Wagner Museum, Universität Würzburg. *Accession no. L282.* Panel A. *Museum der Universität Würzburg Online Collection*. Accessed April 2, 2026.

Panel A, the primary face, depicts five satyrs engaged in the various sequences of winemaking (Fig.1). At the left, a satyr pours water from a hydria into a partially buried pithos; beside him, another plays the double flutes for his working companions. On the right, a satyr harvests grapes from a vine supported by two poles, while another empties a shallow bowl of grapes into a three-handled wicker basket on a raised through at the centre-right of the panel. The last satyr treads the grapes in the basket, from where the pressed juice flows seemingly from a spout into a second pithos buried in the ground below. On the small subsidiary frieze above the panel, Dionysus appears seated on a campstool with a

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[1] Von Bothmer, Dietrich, Amasis, J. Paul Getty Museum., Toledo Museum of Art., Metropolitan Museum of Art, and Los Angeles County Museum of Art. *The Amasis Painter and His World : Vase-Painting in Sixth-Century B.C. Athens*. J. Paul Getty Museum, 1985.

drinking horn, flanked by two Maenads and five dancing satyrs.

Fig. 2. Amasis Painter, *Belly Amphora (Satyr Vase)*, ca. 575–525 BCE. Attic black-figure. Martin von Wagner Museum, Universität Würzburg, L282. Side B. Image: Dietrich von Bothmer, *The Amasis Painter and His World* (Malibu: J. Paul Getty Museum, 1985), no. 19.

Panel B depicts the transformation wrought by wine's consumption (Fig. 2). Dionysus dances frontally toward a satyr in a gesture of comic abandon, and the satyr's head is turned to face the viewer directly. Dionysus wears a long chiton and himation, carries a kantharos in his right hand, and ivy branches in his raised left hand. His head is crowned with an ivy wreath. Two satyrs dance in step behind him; a third carries a wineskin and a fourth plays the pipes. Where panel A shows the ordered, effortful production of wine, panel B renders its divine consequence: the dissolution of ordinary comportment into Dionysiac movement and ecstasy. The lid carries a heraldic animal frieze of sphinxes, lions, sirens, and a swan. The lid knob is in the shape of a pomegranate.

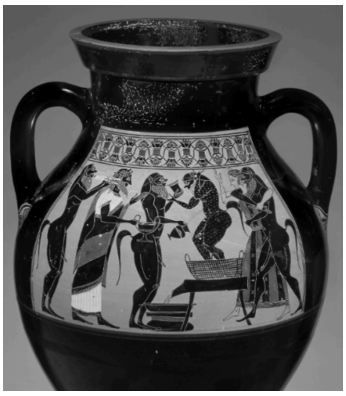

Fig. 3. Athenian black-figure amphora, *Dionysos and Satyrs Making Wine*, ca. 540 BCE. Basel, Antikenmuseum und Sammlung Ludwig, Ka 420. Photo: Andreas F. Voegelin.

Attribution & Dating The vessel is attributed to the Amasis painter by F. Dümmler.[2] The attribution rests on stylistic features characteristic of the Amasis Painter's mature black-figure work: the dense, carefully organised multi-figure compositions, the treatment of satyrs as animalistic yet engaged in purposeful labour, the rendering of the satyrs on side B as physically dynamic rather than static, and the precise incision of interior detailing throughout. The scene on Panel A connects directly to a group of closely related works attributed to the same painter, including the Basel amphora Kä 420 (Fig. 3). Sparkes places this amphora approximately ten years later than the Basel amphora, situating it in the middle period of the Amasis painter's career and supporting a date of c. 540-530 BCE.[3]

[2]Ibid.

[3] Ibid.

Works Cited

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